JARED HOLGATE | SENIOR ENGINEER AND ARCHITECT

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Summary

Focused on building and operating enterprise-grade cloud platform foundations through reusable infrastructure patterns, Terraform/IaC, and continuous delivery. Hands-on technical lead who sets standards, reviews and ships code, and turns strategy into working reference implementations and automation. Comfortable working across product, platform, and customer-facing engineering to drive adoption with maintainable, supportable solutions. Polyglot programmer and fast learner, recently delivering in C#, Go, and TypeScript alongside scripting and automation.

Recent Highlights

- Tech lead, own and maintain Azure Verified Modules (AVM), act as a coach and regularly talk to user groups and partners about AVM and vNext of the Azure Landing Zones modules. Responsible for managing 100's of Terraform repositories at scale with automation.
- Tech lead, develop and maintain the Azure Landing Zones Terraform Accelerator.
- Tech lead and core maintainer of the Azure Landing Zones Terraform modules.
- Developed a state migration tool to aid customers in migrating Terraform workloads to AVM. Published guidance and the tool. Blog post.
- Worked with the Azure DevOps product group to deliver Workload identity federation Terraform capabilities This involved updating the Azure DevOps Terraform Provider (golang), Azure Pipelines Terraform Tasks and the DevLabs Terraform Task (TypeScript).
- Created, published, and maintain several Azure code samples. Examples include GitHub OIDC, Azure DevOps OIDC.
- Regular speaker at internal conferences (LevelUps, TechConnect and TechReady). Write and deliver sessions on AVM, ALZ, and Terraform best practices.
- Co-organiser of the Yorkshire DevOps and Yorkshire Azure User Group meetups. Regular speaker at these and other events.
- Author of Microsoft customer facing training on IaC with Terraform and Bicep in the form of a Value Based Delivery. Continue to maintain it, promote it and help others to deliver it.
- Orchestrated the introduction of ID Token refresh for Azure DevOps and Terraform across multiple Terraform providers and tools. This included writing and releasing v5 of the Azure Pipelines Terraform task: Blog post.

Hands on Technical Skills

Recently hands on with the following technologies, in most cases to expert level;

- Microsoft Azure
- Azure DevOps Service
- GitHub
- Windows Administration
- Linux Administration
- Bash
- PowerShell
- ASP.NET
- C#
- Golang
- JavaScript / TypeScript
- Network Architecture design and implementation
- HashiCorp Terraform
- Technical Writing

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Current Relevant Certifications

- Microsoft Azure Solution Architect Expert
- Microsoft Azure DevOps Engineer Expert
- Microsoft Azure Data Administrator Associate
- Microsoft Azure Network Engineer Associate
- Microsoft Azure Developer Associate
- GitHub Copilot
- GitHub Actions
- HashiCorp Terraform Associate
- BSc (hons) Biomedical Sciences – Sheffield Hallam University

Career History

Microsoft

Global leader in hyperscale cloud and productivity. Products include Azure, M365, GitHub and Azure DevOps.

- **Senior Cloud Solution Architect - Global Customer Success Tech Strategy**
  Leeds (Remote)
  June 2024 to Present

  - Tech lead for Terraform Azure Verified Modules (AVM), supporting module standards and automation at scale. Owner of core networking modules leveraged by 1,000's of customers.
  - Tech lead for Azure Landing Zones Modules, responsible for building and maintaining Terraform Platform Landing Zone modules. Owner of the ALZ IaC Accelerator, used by 1,000's of customers to onboard onto Microsoft Azure.
  - Support global 500 customers with complex and large scale deployments, especially with Infrastructure as Code.

- **Senior Cloud Solution Architect - UK Customer Success Unit**
  Leeds (Remote)
  November 2022 to June 2024 (1 year 7 months)

  - Provide expert level architectural guidance to large scale companies on DevOps, Software Engineering and Cloud Native workloads.
  - Infrastructure as Code and DevOps SME, asked to speak to customers about scaling IaC on a regular basis.
  - Provide customer training on technical subjects.
  - Core maintainer of ALZ Terraform Modules.
  - Maintainer of Azure DevOps Terraform provider and Terraform tasks for Azure DevOps Pipelines.
  - Owner of Terraform customer training materials.

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HashiCorp

World leader in multi cloud adoption. Products include Terraform, Vault, Consul, Nomad and Vagrant.

- **Senior Customer Success Architect**
  Leeds (Remote)
  November 2021 to November 2022 (1 year)

  - Provided expert level architectural guidance to multinational globally recognised companies.
  - Terraform SME (Subject Matter Expert) for HashiCorp, which includes product roadmap presentations.
  - Delivered hands on PoC and demos of Security, Service Mesh Networking and Infrastructure as Code.
  - Plan, design and host webinars to large groups of customers.
  - Contribute code and documentation to HashiCorp products.
  - Author best practice guidance published on HashiCorp websites.
  - Develop and maintain custom tooling used by teams at HashiCorp.
  - Mentor and train junior team members.
  - Collaborate on product development with multiple teams and communicate at all levels.

Maples Group

Global legal and financial services firm, specialising in offshore structures and fund administration.

- **Principal Technical Architect**
  Leeds (Remote)
  April 2019 to October 2021 (2 years 6 months)

  - Reported directly to the CIO, member of the IT Leadership team.
  - Responsible for public and hybrid cloud strategy, delivery and adoption.
  - Support recruiting and developing high performing DevOps teams.
  - Technical consultant across all IT functions and SaaS for business teams.
  - Strong focus on security, work in partnership with CISO.
  - Hands on technical focus across Cloud, SaaS and on prem workloads.
  - Consult with business teams, clients and suppliers.
  - Planned a new flexible office in Leeds and recruited an engineering manager to build the team.
  - Implemented Infrastructure and Code and brought Git to our operations function.

- **Head of Software Engineering**
  Cayman Islands and Montréal
  January 2017 to April 2019 (2 years 3 months)

  - Reported to CIO, member of IT Leadership team.
  - Responsible for 6 Software Engineering Teams and supporting functions (UX, QA, etc)
  - Managed 35 people across 2 locations.
  - Setup new function in Montreal, recruited and onboarded software engineering teams.
  - Got to grips with legacy funds administration code and processes and turned them around.
  - Made major improvements to CI / CD processes and the quality of code.
  - Delivered quality updates and additions to a suite of over 70 internal and client facing products.

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- **Software Development Manager**
  Cayman Islands
  November 2012 to January 2017 (4 years 2 months)

  - Reported directly to CIO
  - Setup a new office and team from scratch in the Cayman Islands.
  - Recruited and onboarded new software engineers, mainly from overseas and relocating.
  - Implemented CI / CD.
  - Upskilled the team with coding practices, such as TDD, SOLID, etc.

- **eCommerce Software Team Leader**
  Leeds
  December 2011 to November 2012 (9 months)

- **Software Developer**
  Leeds
  January 2010 to December 2011 (2 years)

Cascade HR

HR and Payroll software provider.

- **Project Web Developer**
  Leeds
  November 2007 to December 2009 (2 years 1 month)

Skipton Financial Services

Personal financial advisers and money managers, part of Skipton Building Society.

- **Business Systems Developer**
  Skipton
  April 2007 to November 2007 (7 months)

Carlsberg UK Ltd

Global FMCG company producing and exporting beer, wines and spirits.

- **Systems Engineer**
  Leeds
  December 2003 to April 2007 (3 years 4 months)

- **Quality System Manager**
  Leeds
  May 2002 to December 2003 (1 year 7 months)

- **Quality Assurance Technician**
  Leeds
  August 2000 to May 2002 (1 year 3 months)

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Personal Interests

- Exercising daily.
- Distance running.
- Spending time with my wife and children.
- Involvement in the local tech community, attending and organising meetups.
- Live music.
- Diving and snorkelling.
- Learning about what's new in the tech world.
- Reading tech books.